

EKENEKISO UGBANAWAJI LEONARD

BACKEND SOFTWARE ENGINEER - PHP / LARAVEL

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Backend Software Engineer with 6+ years of professional PHP/Laravel experience building multi-tenant SaaS platforms, REST APIs, payment integrations, and business-critical web applications. Strong experience with MySQL, application architecture, testing, production maintenance, code review, and technical leadership. Current professional work is Java/Spring Boot, adding broader backend systems and integration experience to a long-standing PHP/Laravel foundation.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Backend Engineer, Airvend

Nov 2025 - Present | Lagos, Nigeria

- Build and maintain production backend services for financial and value-added-service products using Java and Spring Boot.
- Design REST APIs, transaction workflows, and integrations with internal and third-party systems across B2C and B2B products.
- Troubleshoot application, integration, and data issues while improving validation, failure handling, and production reliability.
- Apply backend architecture and integration patterns that transfer directly across Java/Spring and PHP/Laravel systems.

Software Engineering Team Lead, Boctrust Microfinance Bank

Apr 2024 - Nov 2025 | Lagos, Nigeria

- Led backend and integration work supporting digital banking, lending, direct debit, repayments, and payment workflows.
- Delivered BankOne and NIBSS integrations, including NDD v1/v2, NIP, EasyPay, and iGree BVN consent/identity flows.
- Investigated production issues across application, database, infrastructure, and vendor layers and coordinated technical delivery with external providers.
- Contributed to authentication, access-control, and production security improvements around business-critical financial systems.
- Helped secure a ₦15M eTranzact waiver through technical and vendor coordination.

Backend Developer, Scnip Technology

Jul 2023 - Apr 2024 | Abuja, Nigeria

- Built backend services and APIs for e-learning, payments, subscriptions, user management, and workflow automation.
- Integrated Stripe Connect and other external services with retry handling, error isolation, and resilient third-party communication.
- Improved performance and stability through SQL optimization, targeted caching, backend refactoring, and automated tests around critical workflows.

Technical Team Lead / Full Stack Developer, Harde Business School

Jul 2022 - Mar 2024 | Lagos, Nigeria

- Led development and maintenance of a legacy PHP/Laravel platform supporting academic operations, reporting, staff portals, and internal workflows.
- Delivered Laravel backend features, REST APIs, database changes, and business rules while managing technical debt and preserving established behaviour.
- Improved data integrity and application reliability through validation, MySQL changes, testing, and production issue resolution.
- Led sprint planning, code reviews, technical documentation, and day-to-day implementation decisions after progressing from Full Stack Developer.

Contract Full Stack Developer, Pensuh Innovation

Oct 2018 - Dec 2024 | Anambra, Nigeria

- Built and maintained PHP/Laravel services for a multi-tenant school platform covering enrolment, attendance, academic records, assessments, and tuition payments.
- Implemented tenant-aware data flows, online payment integrations, cloud-backed storage, and reusable Laravel modules across school deployments.
- Worked across REST APIs, MySQL persistence, authentication, frontend integration, and production releases while maintaining existing customer workflows.

SELECTED ENGINEERING WORK

- Credense - Credit & Risk Platform2026
- Built a multi-tenant Laravel 12 platform integrating CRC, CreditRegistry, and FirstCentral bureau data into structured credit assessment workflows.
 - Implemented credit reports, borrower history, repayment schedules, creditor normalization, and configurable DTI, blacklist, score, and risk rules.
 - Built tenant onboarding and operational workflows with an Inertia/React/TypeScript frontend, validation, and reusable application components.

- GlobalPath - AI Mobility Backend
- Delivered a production Java/Spring Boot backend for an AI-backed mobility platform, demonstrating broader backend architecture, API, persistence, and integration experience.
 - Integrated LangChain4j, OpenAI, PostgreSQL, and Pinecone into durable server-side workflows and deployed the backend to Railway.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Technology (B.Tech), Electrical / Electronic EngineeringPort Harcourt, Nigeria | 2019

Rivers State University of Science and Technology

CERTIFICATIONS

Microsoft Certified: Azure Fundamentals 2022

SKILLS

Core Backend PHP 8 • Laravel • REST APIs • Laravel Queues / Jobs • Authentication Data & Caching MySQL • PostgreSQL • Redis • SQL Optimization Laravel / SaaS Multi-Tenancy • Payment Integrations • Background Processing • File / Cloud Storage Frontend TypeScript • React • Vue 3 • Inertia.js • Next.js	Architecture API Design • Domain Modelling • Service Boundaries • Idempotency • Integration Design Cloud & Delivery AWS (EC2, RDS, S3) • Docker • Linux • GitHub Actions • CI/CD Supporting Backend Java • Spring Boot • Spring Data JPA • JPA/Hibernate Quality & Operations PHPUnit / Pest • Unit & Integration Testing • Code Review • Production Debugging
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